

**BIRD OBSERVATION FORM
MOUNTAIN WEST REGION
AMERICAN BIRDS**

56-93-23



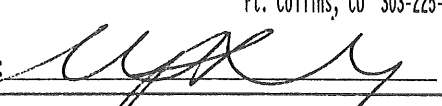
If you watch birds solely for your own enjoyment, a written description of your observations is unnecessary. But, if you have seen something unusual, and would like to share this with other birders, a written description is essential. Compilers of regional bird lists must insist that their records be accurate. Future bird students -- those studying occurrences 50 years from now -- must have a written record on which to depend. By providing the verifying written description, you are helping to further knowledge of bird populations. This procedure is required of all extraordinary observations, regardless of the observer. Thank you for your time.

Common Name: Purple Finch		Weather at time of this observation: Sunny, temperature in mid-40's, little or no wind			
Scientific Name: <i>Carpodacus purpureus</i>					
Obs. Date: January 2, 1993	Time(s): 10:30am				
Duration of obs: 1-2 minutes		Prior weather and number of days since change: Weather had been similar for several days prior to observation			
Distance from bird: 15 feet at first, 40 feet when seen on the ground					
Light Conditions: Bird was backlit; sun was shielded by structure and tree					
Optical Equip.: 10X42 Elites		Locality: Red Rocks Park, in vicinity of Trading Post feeders; Jefferson County <i>COLORADO</i>			
Photo Equip.: none					
Notes made at time of sighting: no	Date report prepared: 1/3/93				
Notes made later from memory: yes					
Enter no. of birds in each category.	GENDER(S)	AGE(S)	PLUMAGE(S)		PHOTO(S)
Total number of birds observed: 1	Males:	Adult: 1	Breeding:	Transition:	Available: no
	Females: 1	Juv/Imm:	Eclipse:	Dark phase:	Enclosed: no
	Fem or Imms:	2/3 yr birds:	Winter:	Light phase:	
	Unknowns:	Unknown:	Other:		

Description of bird: size, colors, all field marks OBSERVED - Unique features of this individual, if any.

Bird was immediately identified as a female *Carpodacus* finch due to heavy facial markings, warm brown coloration on upperparts, rather than dull, gray brown of female House Finch. Compared immediately for size with Siskins and Goldfinches in immediate vicinity which was smaller. Bird was also slightly larger and chunkier than House Finches, but not as large as a House Sparrow, which were also in area. Facial markings were distinct, with sharp contrast between dark brown ear patch outlined by white lines above and below. Distinct malar stripe. Breast heavily streaked, brown streaks on pale white breast; wide, distinct, interrupted markings, ending in mid-belly area. Undertail coverts pale, but unstreaked. This lack of markings under the tail was carefully observed. Bill was finchlike, wide and conical, larger and wider than that of House Finch, dark color. Tail short and forked, seen only from below. Plumage was good, with little evidence of molting or worn feathers.

ATTACH ADDITIONAL NOTES, LISTS OF REFERENCES, SKETCHES FROM LIFE, PHOTOGRAPHS, ETC.

Field marks which were <u>not</u> seen. Why not? All field marks were seen well.	Variations from expected field marks: None observed.
List similar species and describe why or how you eliminated them. Some are described on page 1, under description of bird. Cassin's Finch - Does not have strong contrast from brown ear patch against face, bordered by white. Normally subdued and not as distinct. Coloration was more brownish than gray brownish of Cassin's females. Undertail coverts were not streaked as is nearly always present in female Cassin's. Malar stripe was distinct; it is not normally so in female Cassin's. House Finch - Bird was chunkier, with heavier bill and brownish upperparts as opposed to slim profile and overall gray color of female House Finch. Face was marked with a clear ear patch bordered by white--House Finch females do not have any distinct, concentrated area demarked by white. Malar stripe is also lacking from female house finch and undertail coverts are streaked in House Finch.	
Behavior of this bird. Other species seen with this one. Any interaction between birds? Bird was somewhat cautious and wary of birders watching feeder, but seemed about to feed when first seen about 20 feet off ground in tree. Moments later it was seen on the ground, in the company of goldfinches and siskins but did not stay more than 30 seconds.	
Habitat at this location. Adjacent or near by habitat, if significant. Thick underbrush, with open areas at edges, where seeds such as millet, sunflower and corn were strewn. A few 20 foot trees and shrubs were spaced throughout. Bird landed in one such tree, facing observers, about 15 feet away. This area is a feeding station, with seed, corn and water provided to attract birds. (and birders!)	
Describe bird's song or sounds. No vocalizations were heard.	Print reporter's name, address, phone. Bill and Paula Lisowsky 2919 Silverplume Dr Ft. Collins, CO 303-225-6827 Signature: 
What is your experience with this or similar birds? Both observers are familiar with all three finches likely to be similar appearing to most birders. We have seen thousands of Purple and House Finches and likely hundreds of Cassin's. We are familiar with all plumages of all three species and careful observers.	Corroborating observer not reporting separately:
	Print name:
	Print name:
	Print name:
	Print name: